Aliakbar **AKBARITABAR**

Assistant Professor of Computational Social Science

Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research — University of Rostock, Rostock, Germany

Gender: Male — Year of birth: 1986 — EU-27 permanent resident

akbaritabar@demogr.mpg.de | akbaritabar.github.io | Akbaritabar | Akbaritabar | 0000-0003-3828-1533 | G-Scholar: zufgVroAAAAJ

Summary

Aliakbar Akbaritabar is Assistant Professor of Computational Social Science at the University of Rostock and Research Scientist at the Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research (MPIDR). A computational social scientist trained in sociology, he holds two PhDs, from the University of Milan and Allameh Tabataba'i University. He combines large-scale digital trace data with network analysis to study inequalities in the migration and mobility of scholars and other highly skilled people, and he co-developed the Scholarly Migration Database. His work has appeared in PNAS, PNAS Nexus, Population and Development Review, Quantitative Science Studies and Scientific Data, among other journals. In 2026, he received the EAPS Open Science and Outreach Award and second place in the University of Rostock's Research Data Management Best Practice Award. He co-chairs the IUSSP Panel on Digital Demography, AI, and Open Science (2026–2030).

Research Interests

Computational Social Science Social Network Analysis, Scientific Networks, Social Simulation, Text Analysis

Sociology and Demography Sociology of Science, Bibliometrics, Cyber Social Capital, High-Skilled and Scholarly Migration

Education

Ph.D. in Economic Sociology — University of Milan — *Milan, Italy*

Thesis: A quantitative sociology of academic work in an era of hypercompetition and rankings (1, 2), Supervisor: Flaminio Squazzoni — *Awarded: Apr. 2019*

Ph.D. in Sociology and Social Welfare — Allameh Tabataba'i University — *Tehran, Iran*

Thesis: Iranian's Cyber Social Capital: Background Factors and Outcome (1), Supervisor: Jafar Hezarjaribi — *Awarded: Jun. 2017*

M.A. in Sociology — Tarbiat Modares University — *Tehran, Iran*

Thesis: A Social Network Analysis Study on Online Social Networks: Case study of Doreh and U24, Supervisor: Ali Saei — *Awarded: Jun. 2011*

B.A. in Sociology, Social Research — Shiraz University — *Shiraz, Iran*

Thesis: Factors related with students' commitment to university, Supervisor: Abdolali Lahsaeizadeh — *Awarded: Jun. 2008*

Academic Positions

University of Rostock — Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research — *Rostock, Germany*

Assistant Professor (Junior-Professor) of Computational Social Science (link) — *2025 - present*

Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research — *Rostock, Germany*

Research Scientist (link) — *2021 - 2025*

University of Rostock — *Rostock, Germany*

Adjunct Lecturer (Lehrbeauftragte) (link) — *2025*

Robert K. Merton Center for Science Studies, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin — *Berlin, Germany*

Affiliated Researcher (link) — *2024 - present*

German Centre for Higher Education Research and Science Studies (DZHW) — *Berlin, Germany*

Postdoctoral Researcher — *2018 - 2021*

University of Brescia — *Brescia, Italy*

Researcher - Research Group on Experimental and Computational Sociology (link) — *2016 - 2018*

Yazd University — *Yazd, Iran*

Adjunct Professor — *2013 - 2014*

University of Applied Science and Technology — *Tehran, Iran*

Adjunct Professor — *2012 - 2013*

Research Stays

University College Dublin — *Dublin, Ireland*
Visiting Researcher - Geary Institute — *2018*

Leiden University — *Leiden, the Netherlands*
Visiting Researcher - Centre for Science and Technology Studies (CWTS) — *2018*

École Nationale Supérieure des Télécommunications de Bretagne, IMT Atlantique — *Brest, France*
Visiting Researcher — *2015*

Autonomous University of Barcelona — *Barcelona, Spain*
Visiting Researcher — *2015*

Grants and Funding

2026-2028 **Co-I (210,000€),** International Mobility of Professors at German Universities, Wübben Foundation — *Germany*

2027-2029 **Co-PI (45,000€),** Scientific collaboration between Germany and India, German Research Foundation (DFG) — *Germany*

2023 **PI,** ERC Starting Grant; Migration of scholars worldwide — *European Research Council (ERC)*
Outcome: Grade A (fully meets the excellence criterion; recommended for funding if funds are available)

2015 **PhD Scholarship (40,916€),** University of Milan, Funded by University of Brescia — *Milan, Italy*

2015 **Research Stay Scholarship (6,570€),** Ministry of Science, Research and Technology — *Tehran, Iran*

2015 **Tuition Waiver (490€),** Summer course on Personal Network Analysis at Autonomous University of Barcelona — *Barcelona, Spain*

2015 **Tuition Discount (500€, declined),** Summer course on Big Data and Society at University of Amsterdam — *Amsterdam, the Netherlands*

Honors and Awards

2026 **Award (1,000€): Open Science and Outreach for Population Studies,** European Association for Population Studies (EPC 2026), with Tom Theile (link) — *Bologna, Italy*

2026 **Award (500€): Research Data Management Best Practice - Second place,** University of Rostock (link) — *Rostock, Germany*

2008 **Rank: 7th in demography and 11th in sociology, national MA entrance exam (social sciences)** — *Iran*

Appointment Shortlists and Rankings

2024 **Assistant Professorship in Sociology,** University of Copenhagen — *Copenhagen, Denmark*
Outcome: qualified per the committee's written assessment; not selected

2023 **Assistant Professorship in Computational Social Science,** University of Koblenz — *Koblenz, Germany*
Outcome: 3rd place on the final hiring list (qualified)

Publications

Peer-reviewed journal articles

30. Zhao, X., **Akbaritabar, A.,** Kashyap, R., Zagheni, E., Gender differences in online visibility of early-career researchers. *Nature Communications* (forthcoming).
29. Castro Torres, A. F., Esposito, M., **Akbaritabar, A.,** Global Patterns of Epistemic Hierarchy and Dependency in Scientific Research. *Development and Change* **0,** 1–25. doi:https://doi.org/10.1111/dech.70087 (2026).
28. Rottenkolber, A., Ali, O., Mónus, G., Li, J., Kim, J., Perrotta, D., **Akbaritabar, A.,** The Role of Professional Networks and Institutional Prestige in Shaping the First Career Moves of Scholars. *PNAS Nexus,* pgag168. doi:10.1093/pnasnexus/pgag168 (2026).
27. Zaslavsky, M., **Akbaritabar, A.,** Internal and International Migration of Scholars in Times of Conflict: The Case of Ukraine, 2009-2022. *Population and Development Review* **1,** 1–33. doi:10.1111/padr.70088 (2026).
26. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Dańko, M. J., Zhao, X., Zagheni, E., Global Subnational Estimates of Migration of Scientists Reveal Large Disparities in Internal and International Flows. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* **122,** e2424521122. doi:10.1073/pnas.2424521122 (2025).
25. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Haunschild, R., Bornmann, L., A Study of Gender and Regional Differences in Scientific Mobility and Immobility among Researchers Identified as Potentially Talented. *Journal of Informetrics* **19,** 101744. doi:10.1016/j.joi.2025.101744 (2025).
24. Carrasco, J. I., **Akbaritabar, A.,** Godin, M., Vargas-Silva, C., Prioritizing Global Equity in Migration Research. *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications* **1,** 1–10. doi:10.1057/s41599-025-06308-3 (2025).
23. Torres, A. F. C., **Akbaritabar, A.,** The Hegemonic Use of Linear Models in Quantitative Social Sciences. *Bulletin of Sociological Methodology/Bulletin de Méthodologie Sociologique,* 1–18. doi:10.1177/07591063251349381 (2025).

22. **Akbaritabar, A.** Thinking Spatially in Computational Social Science. *EPJ Data Science* **13,** 1–12. doi:10.1140/epjds/s13688-023-00443-0 (2024).
21. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Castro Torres, A. F., Larivière, V., A Global Perspective on Social Stratification in Science. *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications* **11,** 1–10. doi:10.1057/s41599-024-03402-w (2024).
20. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Rubin, B. P., The Evolution of Plasticity in the Neuroscientific Literature during the Second Half of the Twentieth Century to the Present. *Journal of the History of the Neurosciences.* doi:10.1080/0964704X.2024.2371783 (2024).
19. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Theile, T., Zagheni, E., Bilateral Flows and Rates of International Migration of Scholars for 210 Countries for the Period 1998-2020. *Scientific Data* **11,** 816. doi:10.1038/s41597-024-03655-9 (2024).
18. Castro Torres, A. F., **Akbaritabar, A.,** The Use of Linear Models in Quantitative Research. *Quantitative Science Studies,* 1–32. doi:10.1162/qss_a_00294 (2024).
17. Sanliturk, E., Zagheni, E., Dańko, M. J., Theile, T., **Akbaritabar, A.,** Global Patterns of Migration of Scholars with Economic Development. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* **120.** (Equal contribution of all authors), e2217937120. doi:10.1073/pnas.2217937120 (2023).
16. Zhao, X., **Akbaritabar, A.,** Kashyap, R., Zagheni, E., A Gender Perspective on the Global Migration of Scholars. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences* **120,** e2214664120. doi:10.1073/pnas.2214664120 (2023).
15. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Stephen, D., Squazzoni, F., A Study of Referencing Changes in Preprint-Publication Pairs across Multiple Fields. *Journal of Informetrics* **16,** 101258. doi:10.1016/j.joi.2022.101258 (2022).
14. Piolatto, M., Bianchi, F., Rota, M., Marengoni, A., **Akbaritabar, A.,** Squazzoni, F., The Effect of Social Relationships on Cognitive Decline in Older Adults: An Updated Systematic Review and Meta-Analysis of Longitudinal Cohort Studies. *BMC Public Health* **22,** 278. doi:10.1186/s12889-022-12567-5 (2022).
13. **Akbaritabar, A.** A Quantitative View of the Structure of Institutional Scientific Collaborations Using the Example of Berlin. *Quantitative Science Studies* **2,** 753–777. doi:10.1162/qss_a_00131 (2021).
12. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Barbato, G., An Internationalised Europe and Regionally Focused Americas: A Network Analysis of Higher Education Studies. *European Journal of Education* **56,** 219–234. doi:10.1111/ejed.12446 (2021).
11. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Bravo, G., Squazzoni, F., The Impact of a National Research Assessment on the Publications of Sociologists in Italy. *Science and Public Policy.* doi:10.1093/scipol/scab013 (2021).
10. Gao, D., **Akbaritabar, A.,** Using Agent-Based Modeling in Routine Dynamics Research: A Quantitative and Content Analysis of Literature. *Review of Managerial Science.* doi:10.1007/s11846-021-00446-z (2021).
9. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Squazzoni, F., Gender Patterns of Publication in Top Sociological Journals. *Science, Technology, & Human Values.* doi:10.1177/0162243920941588 (2020).
8. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Traag, V. A., Caimo, A., Squazzoni, F., Italian Sociologists: A Community of Disconnected Groups. *Scientometrics.* doi:10.1007/s11192-020-03555-w (2020).
7. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Casnici, N., Squazzoni, F., The Conundrum of Research Productivity: A Study on Sociologists in Italy. *Scientometrics* **114,** 859–882. doi:10.1007/s11192-017-2606-5 (2018).
6. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Hezarjaribi, J., A comparative study on Cyber Social Capital in Persian, English and French speaking users of Facebook and Google plus. *Quarterly Journal of Socio-Cultural Development Studies* **5,** 175–204. http://journals.sabz.ac.ir/scds/article-1-314-en.html (2016).
5. Nazifi, M., Mokarami, H. R., **Akbaritabar, A.,** FarajiKujerdi, M., Tabrizi, R., Rahi, A., Reliability, Validity and Factor Structure of the Persian Translation of General Health Questionnaire (GHQ-28) in Hospitals of Kerman University of Medical Sciences. *Journal of Fasa University of Medical Sciences* **3,** 336–342. http://jabs.fums.ac.ir/article-1-528-en.html (2014).
4. Nazifi, M., Mokarami, H., **Akbaritabar, A.,** Kalte Haji, O., Rahi, A., Psychometric Properties of the Persian Translation of Pittsburgh Sleep Quality Index. *Health Scope* **3.** doi:10.17795/jhealthscope-15547 (2014).
3. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Mokarami, H., Nazifi, M., Rahi, A., Mirkamandar, E., Hosseinpouri, M., Psychometric properties of Spector's job satisfaction survey in the Iranian population. *Koomesh* **14.** http://koomeshjournal.semums.ac.ir/article-1-1787-en.html (2013).
2. Eskandaripour, E., **Akbaritabar, A.,** Scientific Study of Radio & TV Webpages in Social Websites. *Quarterly Journal of Communication Research* **20,** 113. doi:10.22082/cr.2013.23567 (2013).
1. Shaverdi, M., Heshmati, M. R., Eskandaripour, E., **Akbaritabar, A.,** Developing Sustainable SCM Evaluation Model Using Fuzzy AHP in Publishing Industry. *Procedia Computer Science* **17,** 340–349. doi:10.1016/j.procs.2013.05.044 (2013).

Peer-reviewed conference proceedings

4. Ghorbanpour, F., Malaguth, T. Z., **Akbaritabar, A.,** Differentiating Emigration from Return Migration of Scholars Using Name-Based Nationality Detection Models. *Proceedings of the International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media* **19,** 636–652. doi:10.1609/icwsm.v19i1.35836 (2025).
3. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Haunschild, R., Bornmann, L., *Higher mobility among researchers identified as potentially talented academics compared to a control group* in *Proceedings of The 28th International Conference on Science, Technology and Innovation Indicators* (Berlin, Germany, 2024). doi:10.5281/zenodo.13940222.
2. **Akbaritabar, A.** *Scientific Collaboration Networks in the Interdisciplinary Field of Biodiversity in Central Germany* in *Proceedings of International Society of Scientometrics and Informetrics Conference* (Bloomington, Indiana, 2023). doi:10.5281/zenodo.8253500.
1. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Stahlschmidt, S., *Merits and Limits: Applying open data to monitor open access publications in bibliometric databases* in *Proceedings of the 17th International Conference on Scientometrics and Informetrics, ISSI 2019, Rome, Italy, September 2-5, 2019* (eds Catalano, G., Daraio, C., Gregori, M., Moed, H. F. & Ruocco, G.) (ISSI Society, 2019), 1455–1461.

https://www.issi-society.org/publications/issi-conference-proceedings/proceedings-of-issi-2019/.

Book chapters

2. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Carrasco, J. I., Anastasiadou, A., in *Handbook on International Migration and Social Networks* (eds Bilecen, B. & Lubbers, M. J.) 93–105 (Edward Elgar Publishing, May 2026). doi:10.4337/9781035332328.00016. (2026).
1. Kashyap, R., Rinderknecht, R. G., **Akbaritabar, A.,** Alburez-Gutierrez, D., Gil-Clavel, S., Grow, A., Kim, J., Leasure, D. R., Lohmann, S., Negraia, D. V., Perrotta, D., Rampazzo, F., Tsai, C.-J., Verhagen, M. D., Zagheni, E., Zhao, X., in *Research Handbook on Digital Sociology* 48–86 (Edward Elgar Publishing, 2023). doi:10.4337/9781789906769.00010.

Course and teaching materials

8. **Akbaritabar, A.** Course Computational Approaches to Migration Research. doi:10.5281/zenodo.21419604. (2026).
7. **Akbaritabar, A.** Course Introduction to Computational Social Science. doi:10.5281/zenodo.21419600. (2026).
6. **Akbaritabar, A.** Course Introduction to Demographic Methods. doi:10.5281/zenodo.21419595. (2026).
5. **Akbaritabar, A.** *Materials for Course on Network Tie Formation Mechanisms* Zenodo. 2024. doi:10.5281/zenodo.12737590. (2024).
4. **Akbaritabar, A.** *Materials for Course on BiblioDemography in IMPRS-PHDS 2022: Using Large-Scale Bibliometric Data for Demographic Research* Zenodo. 2022. doi:10.5281/zenodo.12737586. (2024).
3. **Akbaritabar, A.** *Parallelised Analysis of Large-Scale Bibliometric and Text Data (with Dask in Python, DuckDB and DBeaver in SQL)* Zenodo. 2022. doi:10.5281/zenodo.12737596. (2024).
2. **Akbaritabar, A.** *Parallelised and out of Memory Data Analysis Using Dask in Python and DuckDB and DBeaver in SQL* Zenodo. 2022. doi:10.5281/zenodo.12737606. (2024).
1. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Zhao, X., *Materials for Workshop on "Using Bibliometric Data in Demographic Research"* Zenodo. 2022. doi:10.5281/zenodo.12737600. (2024).

Datasets, software, and replication materials

13. **Akbaritabar, A.** Scripts, Data, and Replication Materials for "A Study of Gender and Regional Differences in Scientific Mobility and Immobility among Researchers Identified as Potentially Talented". *Journal of Informetrics.* doi:10.5281/zenodo.17495895 (2025).
12. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Dańko, M. J., *Scripts, Data, and Replication Materials for "Global Subnational Estimates of Migration of Scientists Reveal Large Disparities in Internal and International Flows"* Zenodo. Mar. 2025. doi:10.5281/zenodo.15047102. (2025).
11. Ghorbanpour, F., Malaguth, T., **Akbaritabar, A.,** *Data for the training section of "Differentiating Emigration from Return Migration of Scholars Using Name-Based Nationality Detection Models" paper* Mar. 2025. doi:10.5281/zenodo.15103505. (2025).
10. **Akbaritabar, A.** *Replication Data and Scripts for "Gender and Regional Differences in Scientific Mobility among Academics Identified as Potentially Talented and a Control Group"* 2024. doi:10.17617/3.PQZPDP. (2024).
9. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Castro Torres, A. F., *Replication Data for: A Global Perspective on Social Stratification in Science* Zenodo. June 2024. doi:10.5281/zenodo.12527944. (2024).
8. Theile, T., **Akbaritabar, A.,** Zagheni, E., *Replication Data for: Bilateral Flows and Rates of International Migration of Scholars for 210 Countries and Areas for the Period 1998-2020* May 2024. doi:10.5281/zenodo.11145735. (2024).
7. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Theile, T., Zagheni, E., *Scholarly Migration Database* 2023. https://scholarlymigration.org/.
6. **Akbaritabar, A.** *Scientific Collaborations in Berlin and Halle-Jena-Leipzig Regions Presentation* Zenodo. 2022. doi:10.5281/zenodo.12737580. (2024).
5. **Akbaritabar, A.** *Xaringan Presentation Format with MPIDR Template* Zenodo. 2022. doi:10.5281/zenodo.12737564. (2024).
4. **Akbaritabar, A.** *Scripts Needed to Replicate Methodology Used in "A Quantitative View of the Structure of Institutional Scientific Collaborations Using the Example of Berlin" Published in Quantitative Science Studies.* Zenodo. Apr. 2021. doi:10.5281/zenodo.4657326. (2024).
3. **Akbaritabar, A.** *Google Scholar R Shiny Application* Zenodo. 2020. doi:10.5281/zenodo.12737546. (2024).
2. **Akbaritabar, A.** *Kalick and Hamilton, 1986, Agent Based Model Replicated Using Mesa in Python* Zenodo. 2020. doi:10.5281/zenodo.12737542. (2024).
1. **Akbaritabar, A.** *Replication Materials for "The Impact of a National Research Assessment on the Publications of Sociologists in Italy" to Appear in Science and Public Policy* Zenodo. Aug. 2020. doi:10.5281/zenodo.3974108. (2024).

Preprints and working papers

12. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Castro Torres, A. F., Zagheni, E., *Internationally Mobile Researchers Contribute to Scientific Production Far beyond Their Share in the Population* tech. rep. WP-2026-009 (Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research, Rostock, Mar. 2026). doi:10.4054/MPIDR-WP-2026-009. (2026).

11. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Theile, T., Zagheni, E., *Bilateral Flows and Rates of Subnational and International Migration of Scholars Worldwide by Gender and Field* tech. rep. WP-2026-029 (Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research, Rostock, May 2026). doi:10.4054/MPIDR-WP-2026-029. (2026).
10. Kim, J. S., Carrasco Armijo, J. I., Vishnoi, S., Liang, Y., Lauber, M., Cortes, J. D., **Akbaritabar, A.,** Basellini, U., Zagheni, E., *Global Improvements in the Representation of Women in Science Are Stalling* tech. rep. WP-2026-019 (Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research, Rostock, May 2026). doi:10.4054/MPIDR-WP-2026-019. (2026).
9. Slocombe, H., Rowe, F., **Akbaritabar, A.,** *Global Sequencing of Researcher Migration Reveals Factors Associated with Disparities in Subnational Patterns of Brain Gain and Drain* tech. rep. WP-2026-018 (Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research, Rostock, May 2026). doi:10.4054/MPIDR-WP-2026-018. (2026).
8. Zhou, H., **Akbaritabar, A.,** Sun, M., Zagheni, E., Nunes Amaral, L. A., *A Natural Experiment Reveals the Impact of Geopolitical Shocks on the Trajectory of a Nation's Scientific Enterprise* tech. rep. WP-2026-026 (Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research, Rostock, May 2026). doi:10.4054/MPIDR-WP-2026-026. (2026).
7. Walk, E., **Akbaritabar, A.,** *Resolving the Paradox between Migration and Collaboration of Scholars Worldwide* Aug. 2024. doi:10.31235/osf.io/g2u6v. (2024).
6. Abdi Nur, A., **Akbaritabar, A.,** Vignau Loria, M., Coolman, N., Fan, X., Curran, S., *Bibliometric Analysis of Published Literature on the Determinants of Family Planning* tech. rep. WP-2023-027 (Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research, Rostock, 2023). doi:10.4054/MPIDR-WP-2023-027.
5. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Stephen, D., *A Case-Control Study of Differences in the Review Process between Peer Review and Other Research Manuscripts: Study Protocol* SSRN Scholarly Paper. Rochester, NY, Sept. 2023. https://ssrn.com/abstract=4569653 (2024).
4. Gao, D., **Akbaritabar, A.,** *Motivations Behind Scholarly Collaboration and Migration: An Agent-Based Model* 2023.
3. **Akbaritabar, A.** *Dichotomy of Offline Versus Online Social Capital* SSRN Scholarly Paper. Rochester, NY, 2022. doi:10.2139/ssrn.4311832.
2. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Stahlschmidt, S., *Applying Crossref and Unpaywall Information to Identify Gold, Hidden Gold, Hybrid and Delayed Open Access Publications in the KB Publication Corpus* Preprint (SocArXiv, 2019). doi:10.31235/osf.io/sdzft.
1. **Akbaritabar, A.,** Hezarjaribi, J., Jullien, N., A Tool for Dynamic Measurement of Social Capital Embedded in Online Social Networks. *Grafo Working Papers* **4,** 1–30. doi:10.5565/rev/grafowp.14 (2015).

Dissertations and other publications

5. **Akbaritabar, A.** *Quantitative Sociology of Academic Work in an Era of Hypercompetition and Rankings* PhD thesis (Università degli Studi di Milano, 2019). doi:10.13130/AKBARITABAR-ALIAKBAR_PHD2019-04-16.
4. **Akbaritabar, A.** *Interactive Dashboard on Key Actors in Higher Education Research and Science Studies (HERSS)* German Centre for Higher Education Research and Science Studies (DZHW). Federal Ministry of Education and Research (BMBF), 2018. https://akbaritabar.github.io/CV_MD/herss_world_map_flexdashboard.html.
3. **Akbaritabar, A.** *Iranian's Cyber Social Capital; Background Factors and Outcome* PhD thesis (Allameh Tabataba'i University, Tehran, Iran, 2017).
2. Squazzoni, F., **Akbaritabar, A.,** Internationalizing Sociology in Italy, 1970s-2010s. *Global Dialogue* **7,** 10–11. https://globaldialogue.isa-sociology.org/articles/internationalizing-sociology-in-italy-1970s-2010s (2017).
1. **Akbaritabar, A.** *A study on online social networks: case study of Doreh and U24* Master of Sociology (Tarbiat Modares University, Tehran, Iran, 2011).

Supervision and Mentoring

2026 - **Co-supervisor,** *University of Rostock, MPIDR*
PhD student, Paul Bachmann, MPIDR and University of Rostock, Germany

2026 **Supervisor / Advisor and evaluator,** *University of Rostock*
Master theses, Sociology and Demography: Tom Weick (supervisor), **Title**: Predicting Scholarly Migration Using Bibliometric Data And Machine Learning; **Outcome**: successfully defended; Christin Heitmann (advisor)

2023 - **Co-organizer and Mentor,** *MPIDR*
The **Population and Social Data Science Summer Incubator Program**, weekly mentorship meetings with PhD students, co-supervised with U. Basellini and E. Zagheni (6 students, 15 tutorials; working paper), D. Perrotta and J. Kim (4 students; PNAS Nexus paper), and A. Castro and I. Chen (4 students; **Project**: Spatial mobility and scientific production, link)

2024 - **Co-supervisor,** *University of Rostock, MPIDR*
PhD student, Thiago Zordan Malaguth, MPIDR and University of Rostock, Germany

2024 **Course Coordinator,** *MPIDR*
International Max Planck Research School for Population, Health and Data Science (IMPRS-PHDS) course on Topics in Digital and Computational Demography (link)

Co-organizer and Facilitator,
2023-2024 Soft skills seminars for PhD students, 1-hour seminars with invited speakers: 12 in 2023 (one as the speaker on Biases in Science, slides) and 11 in 2024 — *MPIDR*

Advisor and Supervisor of visiting students,
2021-2025 Huaxia Zhou (PhD student, Physics, Northwestern University, US; advisor, 2024-2025; working paper); Aasli Abdi Nur (PhD student, Sociology, University of Washington, US; advisor, 2024); Faeze Ghorbanpour (Computer Science, Sharif University of Technology, Iran; supervisor, 2023-2024; ICWSM paper); Maria Vignau Loria (PhD student, Sociology, University of Washington, US; advisor, 2021-2022; working paper) — *MPIDR*

Course Coordinator,
2023 International Max Planck Research School for Population, Health and Data Science (IMPRS-PHDS) course on Topics in Digital and Computational Demography (link) — *MPIDR*

EDSD mentor,
2023-2024 Thiago Zordan Malaguth, European Doctoral School of Demography (EDSD) — *MPIDR*

Training Advisor,
2022-2024 Monthly progress meetings with 10 PhD students and yearly feedback to them and their postdoc mentors (as Deputy Head for Training) — *MPIDR*

Advisor,
2021-2024 PhD student, Xinyi Zhao, PhD student of Sociology (PNAS paper) — *MPIDR, University of Oxford*

Supervisor,
2021-2022 Master Student (as a research assistant) — *MPIDR, Rostock*

Supervisor,
2019-2021 2 Master Students (as research assistants) — *DZHW, Berlin*

Teaching Experience

SoSe 2027 **Introduction to Demographic Methods**, Master level course, 13 weeks, at the University of Rostock (link) — *Rostock*

WS 2026 **Computational Approaches to Migration Research**, Master level course, 14 weeks, at the University of Rostock (link) — *Rostock*

2026 **Interactive Course on Git, GitHub, and Version Control**, European Population Conference (materials) — *Bologna, Italy*

SoSe 2026 **Introduction to Demographic Methods**, Master level course, 13 weeks, at the University of Rostock (link) — *Rostock*

WS 2025 **Computational Approaches to Migration Research**, Master level course, 14 weeks, at the University of Rostock (link) — *Rostock*

SoSe 2025 **Introduction to Computational Social Science**, Master level course, 13 weeks, at the University of Rostock as Adjunct Lecturer (Lehrbeauftragte, link) — *Rostock*

2025 **Tutorial on Using version control, Git and GitHub for Open Science**, Second MPIDR Open Science workshop (materials) — *Rostock*

2024 **Migration and Society - Week 7: Migration Networks**, Master level course at the University of Rostock and MPIDR — *Rostock*

2024 **Network tie formation mechanisms**, Population and Social Data Science Summer Incubator Program (materials) — *Rostock - Virtual*

2024 **Using digital trace data to study the migration of scholars**, IMPRS-PHDS, IDEM187, MPIDR, hybrid 100+ students (outline) — *Rostock - Virtual*

2023 **Using digital trace data to study the migration of scholars**, IMPRS-PHDS, IDEM187, MPIDR, hybrid 100+ students (outline) — *Rostock - Virtual*

2022 **Using digital trace data to study the migration of scholars**, IMPRS-PHDS, IDEM187, MPIDR, hybrid 100+ students (materials) — *Rostock - Virtual*

2022 **Parallelized analysis of bibliometric and text data using Python and SQL**, University of Toronto (materials) — *Virtual*

2022 **Using bibliometric data in demographic research**, European Population Conference, with Xinyi Zhao (materials) — *Groningen - Virtual*

2022 **Introduction to text analysis and bibliometric data**, Population and Social Data Science Summer Incubator Program (materials) — *Rostock - Virtual*

2022 **Parallelized analysis of bibliometric and text data using Python and SQL**, University of Michigan (materials) — *Virtual*

2019 **Introduction to network analysis**, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin (materials) — *Berlin, Germany*

2013-2014 **Adjunct Professor,** Yazd University, courses taught: Basic Sociology (2 semesters); Sociology of Third World countries; Sociology of Delinquent Behavior; Sociology of Social Stratification and Inequalities (2 semesters) — *Yazd, Iran*

2012-2013 **Adjunct Professor,** University of Applied Science and Technology, courses taught: Basic Sociology; Basics of Iranian Social History — *Tehran, Iran*

2011-2015 **Workshop Instructor,** Social network analysis, invited by various institutions (visual history) — *Iran*

Professional Service and Event Organization

2026-2030 **Co-Chair,** Panel on Digital Demography, AI, and Open Science of the International Union for the Scientific Study of Population (IUSSP) (link) — *Global*

2025- **Open Science Ambassador,** Max Planck Society (link) — *Germany*

2021- **Faculty Member,** International Max Planck Research School for Population, Health and Data Science (IMPRS-PHDS), MPIDR — *Rostock, Germany*

2022-2024 **Deputy Head for Training,** Department of Digital and Computational Demography (DiCoDe), MPIDR — *Rostock, Germany*

2021-2024 **Executive Committee Member,** DiCoDe, MPIDR — *Rostock, Germany*

2022-2023 **Coordinator, Local Friend System,** DiCoDe, MPIDR; supporting newcomers' settlement — *Rostock, Germany*

2021-2022 **Deputy Head, Laboratory of Migration and Mobility,** DiCoDe, MPIDR — *Rostock, Germany*

2022 **Chair, Seminar Series,** DiCoDe, MPIDR; 18 weekly seminars, 14 with external invited speakers — *Rostock, Germany*

2024 **Symposium Co-organizer,** Migration and Mobility Symposium at MPIDR and online (link) — *Rostock, Germany*

2023 **Workshop (Member Initiated Meeting) Organizer,** with 8 invited speakers at the 88th PAA Annual Meeting on the inauguration of the Scholarly Migration Database (link) — *New Orleans, USA*

2023 **Suessmilch Lecture Host and Organizer,** Invited and hosted Cassidy R. Sugimoto for her lecture on "Equity for Women in Science" (link) — *Rostock, Germany*

2022 **Workshop Organizer,** with 6 invited speakers at European Population Conference on using bibliometric data for demographic research (link) — *Groningen, the Netherlands*

2020 **Conference Session Organizer,** with Vacca, Raffaele; McCarty, Christopher; Squazzoni, Flaminio on Network Analysis for the Science of Science, 40th INSNA Sunbelt conference — *Virtual*

2020 **Co-organizer of the second satRday conference in Berlin,** A conference for R users, canceled due to COVID-19 (link) — *Berlin, Germany*

2019 **Co-organizer of the first satRday conference in Berlin,** A conference for R users (link) — *Berlin, Germany*

Reviewing Activities

"**" indicates multiple reviews.

Journals	Nature, Science Advances, Demography**, American Sociological Review, Quantitative Science Studies**, Social Networks, Journal of Informetrics**, Nature - Humanities and Social Sciences Communications**, Journal of Open Source Software**, Global Networks, Applied Network Science, Science and Public Policy**, Scientometrics**, European Journal of Education, PLOS ONE**, EPJ Data Science, Migration Studies, JASSS
Verified Reviews	Web of Science reviewer profile (`https://www.webofscience.com/wos/author/record/66657430`)
Grants	Swiss National Science Foundation (SNSF)
Conferences	IC2S2 2025, IPC-IUSSP 2025, IC2S2 2024, PAA 2024, STI 2024, STI 2022, ISSI 2021, Sunbelt 2020, ISSI & STI 2019, STI 2018
Award Committee	IMPRS-PHDS Annual Academy poster award, 2021 INSNA-Sunbelt Richards Software Award
Topic Co-Editor	Frontiers in Research Metrics and Analytics
Panel Member	2021 INSNA Diversity, Equity and Inclusion Panel

Invited Talks

2026	**Mobility, Migration, and Collaboration of the Highly-Skilled, Scholars, and Professionals**, Institute of Advanced Study (IAST), Toulouse School of Economics (link)	*Toulouse, France*
2026	**Mobility, Migration, and Collaboration of Scholars**, Center for Computational Social Sciences (CCSS) Seminars, Koç University (Recording)	*Virtual*
2025	**A global perspective on social stratification in science**, European Society of Historical Demography (Recording)	*Virtual*
2025	**Keynote: Mobility, Migration, and Collaboration of Scholars**, Government Policies and Scientific Collaboration (GPSC) symposium, University of Leiden (link)	*Virtual*
2025	**Using Digital Trace Data to Differentiate Emigration from Return Migration of Scholars**, RISIS research seminars (link)	*Virtual*
2025	**Keynote: Mobility, Migration, and Collaboration of Scholars**, Second workshop on Methods for the analysis of scientific collaboration networks, University of Catania	*Catania, Italy*
2024	**Using Digital Trace Data to Differentiate Emigration from Return Migration of Scholars**, Center for Studies in Demography and Ecology (CSDE), University of Washington	*Virtual*
2024	**The Scholarly Migration Database**, International Organization for Migration (IOM) (slides)	*Berlin, Germany*
2024	**A global perspective on social stratification in science**, Centre for Demographic Studies (CED), Autonomous University of Barcelona	*Barcelona, Spain*
2024	**The Scholarly Migration Database**, Webinar on innovations in data infrastructure for the longitudinal study of international migration, IUSSP Scientific Panel on Lifetime Migration (Recording)	*Virtual*
2023	**Quantifying the mobility and migration of scholars worldwide**, Scientific Mobility Conference, University of Granada	*Virtual*
2022	**Internal and international migration of scholars worldwide**, RISIS research seminars (link)	*Virtual*
2022	**Methodological monotheism across fields of science in contemporary quantitative research**, Canada Research Chair on the Transformations of Scholarly Communication (with Andres Castro)	*Virtual*
2022	**Plasticity: the anchor concept of the neurosciences**, Robert K. Merton Center for Science Studies, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin (with Beatrix Rubin)	*Berlin, Germany*
2022	**Internal and international migration of scholars worldwide**, Canada Research Chair on the Transformations of Scholarly Communication	*Virtual*
2021	**Internal and international migration of scholars worldwide**, 3rd Thematic workshop "Migration and Big Data", French Collaborative Institute on Migration, CNRS (Recording)	*Virtual*
2020	**Italian sociologists: a community of disconnected groups**, The Mitchell Centre for Social Network Analysis seminars (Recording)	*Virtual*
2020	**A Network Analysis Study on the Internationalization of Higher Education Research**, University College London (UCL), workshop for the special issue of European Journal of Education (with Giovanni Barbato)	*Virtual*
2019	**Merits and Limits: Applying open data to monitor open access publications in bibliometric databases**, Workshop on Matching procedures for Unpaywall and Web of Science, Bielefeld University	*Bielefeld, Germany*
2019	**A spatial scientometric and network analysis of Higher Education Research and Science Studies (HERSS)**, International symposium on Academia in the Age of Comparison, Leibniz Center for Science and Society (LCSS) of Hanover University	*Hanover, Germany*
2019	**Dashboards for academic reports? Introducing Key Actors in Higher Education Research and Science Studies (HERSS Dashboard)**, Research Colloquium, German Centre for Higher Education Research and Science Studies (DZHW)	*Berlin, Germany*
2018	**A quantitative sociology of academic work in an era of hypercompetition and rankings**, Centre for Science and Technology Studies (CWTS) seminars	*Leiden, the Netherlands*
2018	**Gender and ethnic patterns of publication in top sociology journals**, Research Group in Experimental and Computational Sociology, University of Brescia	*Brescia, Italy*
2017	**Cyber Social Capital: A comparative SNA study on a sample of English, French and Persian speaking users of Facebook and Google plus**, Iranian Sociological Association	*Tehran, Iran*
2017	**Contexts that matter the most: Institutional embeddedness of research productivity of sociologists in Italy**, Research Group in Experimental and Computational Sociology, University of Brescia	*Brescia, Italy*

2013 **Organizational Network Analysis: How Social Media will change the way Information is shared in Organizations**, *Tehran, Iran*
Second National Conference on Social Media day

2013 **How Online Social Networks shape youth's Lifestyle and Leisure time**, *Shiraz, Iran*
National Congress on Lifestyle and Leisure Time

2011 **Book-based Group Activities in Social Networking Sites, Case study of U24.ir**, *Tehran, Iran*
Conference on Book and Social Media

2011 **How to use SNA in study of online social networks**, *Tehran, Iran*
Conference on Online Social Networks and Everyday Life

2011 **Youth Responsibility In Online Social Networks: Case Study of U24.ir**, *Shiraz, Iran*
National Conference on Youth Responsibility

Conference Presentations

IC^{2}S^2 - International Conference on Computational Social Science

2015, Northwestern University; 2019, Amsterdam; 2021, ETH Zurich; 2022, Chicago - Virtual (1 talk, 1 poster); 2023, Copenhagen (3 talks, 1 poster); 2024, Philadelphia (1 talk as co-author); 2025, Norrköping (1 talk as co-author, 2 posters)

PAA - Annual Meeting of the Population Association of America

2022, Atlanta - Virtual (2 talks); 2023, New Orleans (1 workshop with 8 invited speakers); 2024, Columbus (2 as co-author, 2 posters, 1 session as discussant); 2025, Washington, D.C. (2 talks as co-author)

EPC - European Population Conference || IPC - International Population Conference

2021, IPC Virtual (2 talks); 2022, EPC Groningen (1 talk, 1 workshop with 6 invited speakers); 2024, EPC Edinburgh (3 as co-author, 1 talk); 2025, IPC Brisbane (2 talks as co-author); 2026, EPC Bologna (2 talks, 1 as co-author)

INSNA Sunbelt - International Network for Social Network Analysis

2015, Brighton; 2018, Utrecht; 2020, Virtual (1 organized track); 2021, Networks 2021: A Joint Sunbelt and NetSci Conference; 2022, Cairns - Virtual (2 talks); 2023, Portland - Virtual (2 talks)

NetSci - International School and Conference on Network Science || EUSN - European Conference on Social Networks

2016, EUSN Paris; 2021, Networks 2021: A Joint Sunbelt and NetSci Conference, Virtual; 2023, NetSci Vienna (1 talk, 1 session as chair)

ISSI - International Society for Scientometrics and Informetrics || STI - Science, Technology and Innovation Indicators

2019, Rome; 2023, Indiana - Virtual; 2024, STI Berlin

Other Conferences

2010, Integrated Conference of Metallurgy Engineers, Tehran; 2011, National Conference on Medical Education, Mashhad

Other Sociology or Demography Conferences

2011, International Technology, Education and Development (INTED) Conference, Valencia - Virtual; 2019, Conferenza Nazionale delle Dottorande e dei Dottorandi in Scienze Sociali, Sapienza University, Rome; 2018, Rome and 2020, Valencia - Virtual, New Frontiers of Peer Review (PEERE); 2021, Methodological Innovations in Research on Spatial Mobility: Potentials and Pitfalls, Hanover - Virtual; 2022, IMISCOE annual conference, Oslo - Virtual; 2023, AISP-SIS, PopDays, Rome; 2023, German Federal Institute for Population Research 50th anniversary, Wiesbaden; 2023, British Society for Population Studies Annual Conference (BSPS), Keele; 2025, 5th Conference of German Academy of Sociology, Mainz; 2025, Wittgenstein Centre Conference on Migration, Vienna

Society Memberships

International Union for the Scientific Study of Population (IUSSP)
Population Association of America (PAA)
European Association for Population Studies (EAPS)
International Migration Research Network (IMISCOE)
International Network for Social Network Analysis (INSNA)
Iranian National Association of Social Welfare

Media and Press Coverage

2026 **Scholars in Ukraine (PDR)**,
MPIDR, Max Planck Society, EurekAlert, Phys.org, ScholarPeer, NV Techno (Ukrainian)

2026 **Scholar migration by gender and field (working paper)**,
Tia Sáng (Vietnamese)

2026 **EAPS Open Science and Outreach Award**,
University of Rostock (German), MPIDR

2026 **First career moves of scholars (PNAS Nexus)**,
Complexity Science Hub

2025-2026 **Equity in migration research (HSSC)**,
MPIDR, Max Planck Society, University of Oxford, Population Europe

2025-2026 **Subnational migration of scientists (PNAS)**,
MPIDR, Max Planck Society, University World News

2025 **Junior professorship**,
MPIDR

2024 **Scholarly migration and scientific mobility**,
MPIDR

2024 **Social stratification in science (HSSC)**,
Cosmos

2023 **Migration of scholars and economic development (PNAS)**,
MPIDR, Phys.org, EurekAlert

2023 **Scholarly Migration Database**,
MPIDR

2023 **Gender gap among migrant scientists (PNAS)**,
Podcast guest, PNAS Science Sessions (with X. Zhao, R. Kashyap, E. Zagheni); MPIDR, University of Oxford, EurekAlert, Times Higher Education, Nature, Physics World

2022 **Bibliometric data for demographic research**,
Interview, MPIDR

2021 **New researcher at the Digital and Computational Demography Lab**,
Interview, MPIDR

2015 **Social Village**,
Interview, M@rsouin institute

Public Outreach and Other Service

2026 **Awesome Demographic Methods**,
An awesome curated list of resources for Demographic Methods (link)

2023 **Contributor**,
Awesome Computational Social Science GitHub Repository (link)

2023 **Written post**,
IUSSP, description of the workshop on the inauguration of the Scholarly Migration Database at PAA2023 (link)

2022 **Written post**,
IUSSP, description of the workshop on using bibliometric data for demographic research (link)

2022 **Contributor**,
Published social network surveys and software GitHub repository (link)

2022 **Public talk**,
African Science Day titled “Development and Global Migration of Scholars: Trends and Patterns revealed by Bibliometric Data”, African Development Initiative e.V. (ADI e.V.), Rostock, Germany

2022 **Translator**,
Contributed to the Persian translation of the Declaration on Research Assessment (DORA) (link)

2020- **Maintainer**,
Calendar of Computational Social Science Events Worldwide (link)

2011-2015 **Blogger**,
Accessible scientific content about Social Network Analysis (104 posts in Persian) (link)

Additional Training

Supervising Doctoral Researchers — *Rostock, Germany*
Instructor: Thomas Koch at Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research — *04-05/09/2025*

Data Visualization Design — *Rostock, Germany*
Instructor: Jonas Schöley at Max Planck Institute for Demographic Research (link) — *23-27/06/2025*

Building and Managing Your Research Group — *Virtual*
Instructor: Thomas Koch at Planck Academy of the Max Planck Society (link) — *29-30/04/2025*

10th Annual Berkeley Workshop in Formal Demography — *Berkeley, USA*
Instructors: Robert Chung, Dennis Feehan, Ayesha Mahmud, Joshua Goldstein at UC Berkeley (link) — *03-07/06/2024*

Introduction to Machine Learning and Predictive Modeling — *Rostock, Germany*
Instructor: Samin Aref from University of Toronto hosted at MPIDR (link) — *05/2023*

Media Training Workshop — *Virtual*
Instructors from Econnect Communication (link) — *15-16/05/2023*

Inspirational Leadership and Supervision — *Rostock, Germany*
Instructor: Daniel Mertens (link) — *21-22/02/2023*

Science of Science Summer School (S4) — *Virtual*
School of Information Studies at Syracuse University — *26-30/07/2021 - 02-06/08/2021*
Instructors: Daniel Acuña, Stephen David, et al. (link)

Topics in Digital and Computational Demography — *Virtual*
International Max Planck Research School for Population, Health and Data Science (IMPRS-PHDS, IDEM187) — *9-13/11/2020*
Instructors: Diego Alburez-Gutierrez, Samin Aref, André Grow, Emilio Zagheni (link)

Summary of 12 methods schools and workshops, 2015-2019 — *Various*
Personal network analysis (Barcelona 2015); ERGM, RSiena, TERGM and social networks and organizations (Lugano, Paris 2016); agent-based modeling (Brescia 2016, 2017); Python (Trento 2017); RSiena and network visualization (Utrecht 2018); VOSviewer (Leiden 2018); academic writing (Berlin 2019) — *2015-2019*

Skills

Languages	**Persian (Farsi)** and **Qashqai**: as mother tongues; **English**: TOEFL iBT 2015, 96/120 (R: 23, L: 24, S: 22, W: 27); **Arabic**: Basic level in reading and writing; **Italian**: B1, University of Bergamo certificate; **German**: B1, TELC certificate, B2.2, and C1, University of Rostock certificates.
Programming	**R and Python**: Parallelized extract, transform, and load (ETL), network analysis, text analysis, web scraping, dynamic reports, Shiny, R Markdown, Quarto; **SQL**: Tabular databases: Oracle, PostgreSQL; In-memory databases: DuckDB; Graph databases: ArangoDB; **Scientific workflows**: Snakemake
Statistical	SPSS, Stata, R, Python
Networks	iGraph, Pajek, Ucinet, NodeXL, Gephi, Cytoscape
Simulation	Agent-Based Modeling (ABM) in NetLogo and Mesa Python
Version control	Git, GitHub, GitLab
Office; OS	Microsoft Office Programs, LibreOffice; Windows, Linux, macOS
Typesetting	LaTeX, Markdown
Qualitative	RQDA
IDE	VS Code, Jupyter, RStudio, DBeaver, Command-line terminal
Cloud computing	Amazon AWS and SageMaker; Databricks; Google Colaboratory
Other	• 01/06/2023 - present, **Certified fire protection helper** (Brandschutzhelfer) at MPIDR, training at AFZ Rostock • 24/02/2024 - present, **Certified first aid helper** at MPIDR, training at both AFZ and Malteser Rostock • 2024, Certificate for **Good Clinical Practice in Social and Behavioral Research** course by the National Institutes of Health • Running and cycling (Strava personal, DemogRunners club)